

From a Trainer 360 AI Enablement to AI Design

What to Use and When™

Choose the right AI tool for the job — and build learning assets faster.

Which AI tool should you use — and when — to create slides,
videos, graphics, narration, and learning assets
without wasting hours comparing tools.

Stop guessing which AI tool to use. Start building learning assets faster.

You don't need another AI tools list. You need a decision system.

Hundreds of AI tools. New “Top 20” lists every week.	More time comparing tools than actually building anything.	Decision fatigue. Deadline stress. A half-finished deck.
--	--	--

You're not lazy. You're not behind. You're just stuck in decision fatigue.

This guide is a tool-to-task decision system. It shows you which AI tools are right for common instructional design jobs — and *when* to use each one — so you can move faster and stop second-guessing yourself.

What you'll be able to do

- Select the most appropriate AI tool for common learning design tasks
- Identify where AI tools fit within the ADDIE process
- Build a simple AI-enabled learning asset workflow
- Reduce tool-selection decision fatigue and work more efficiently

If you're new to AI for learning design

Start with these three tools:

1. **ChatGPT or Claude** — content and structure
2. **Canva** — design and visual polish
3. **Gamma** — rapid slide creation

Most instructional designers can achieve significant productivity gains with these tools before investing in a larger AI stack.

The Trainerfy360 Recommended Stack

Not a sponsored list. Just what works.

Research	Perplexity + NotebookLM
Content drafting	Claude or ChatGPT
Slides	Gamma → Canva
Design & graphics	Canva AI

Video	HeyGen
Voice	ElevenLabs
eLearning	Storyline
Model comparison	Multi (getmulti.ai)

Compliance note (Australia-friendly): If you're working with sensitive or regulated data, check your organisation's AI and data policies before uploading SME notes or internal content to cloud-based tools.

The AI Tool-to-Task Matrix

For each task, here's the recommended tool — and why.

This is the page you'll come back to again and again. Short, searchable, and practical.

Task	Recommended tool	Why it fits	Best for
Create a workshop deck from scratch	Gamma	Fast structure, clean slides, minimal friction	Quick decks, first drafts, time-crunch days
Create a web-based course quickly	Rise (Articulate 360)	Fast authoring, responsive design, AI-assisted	Mobile-friendly courses, quick rollouts
Refine and brand existing slides	Canva	Magic Edit, brand kits, easy polish	Making things look “done” without a designer
Create a short explainer video (avatar)	HeyGen	AI avatars + script-to-video, fast turnaround	Quick explainers, onboarding, simple concepts
Create a short explainer video (animation)	Vyond	AI scripts, scenes, characters, animation	Animated training, scenarios, storytelling
Create narration without hiring talent	ElevenLabs	Natural-sounding voice, voice cloning	Voiceover without mic stress or studio time
Edit video + add captions easily	Descript	Edit video by editing text, captions, overdub	Fast video edits, captioning, quick fixes
Create an infographic or job aid	Canva AI	Templates, Magic Edit, fast visuals	Quick graphics that don't look generic
Build interactive eLearning	Storyline	Full control, scenarios, branching	eLearning that feels real, not flabby
Generate images for learning content	Midjourney, DALL·E 3, or ChatGPT	Better quality or faster generation depending on tool	Branded visuals, concept art, placeholder images
Record software training	Camtasia	Screen recording + editing, industry standard	Software demos, step-by-step training
Draft content, scripts, and outlines	Claude or ChatGPT	Structured drafting, distilling, long-form writing	Scripts, outlines, summarised SME content
Research trends, tools, and data	Perplexity or Gemini	Fast, cited answers, research-friendly	Fact-checks, trend scans, background research
Synthesise research, source docs, SME content	NotebookLM	Upload sources, ask questions, audio overviews	Deep synthesis, dense docs into usable content
Research, ideation, Google Workspace tasks	Gemini (Google)	Tight Google integration, multimodal, fast	Google Workspace teams, research + drafting
Compare AI model outputs side by side	Multi (getmulti.ai)	Run any prompt across multiple models simultaneously	Prompt testing, picking the best model for a task
Collaborative course creation + LMS	360Learning	AI-assisted creation, collaborative LMS	Teams that want creation + distribution together

This isn't a ranking. It's a “recommended fit for this job” map. Your stack may vary, but the logic is the same.

AI-Enabled ADDIE: Where tools fit in your project

How AI tools map to each stage of a learning project

You already know ADDIE. This is ADDIE, but with AI doing the heavy lifting where it makes sense.

Stage	Common tasks	AI tools that help
Analyse	Gather needs, clarify objectives, understand audience	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, NotebookLM
Design	Structure content, outline activities, draft scripts	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Canva
Develop	Build slides, videos, graphics, eLearning	Gamma, Rise, Storyline, HeyGen, Vyond, ElevenLabs, Canva, Descript
Implement	Deploy through LMS, deliver workshops, share videos	LMS, 360Learning, video platforms, Camtasia
Evaluate	Collect feedback, analyse results, iterate	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, forms, survey tools, LMS analytics

The same tool can appear in multiple stages. That's fine — ADDIE isn't a straight line, and neither is AI.

Common L&D; scenarios: “I need...”

What to use when the clock is ticking

These are the exact scenarios we hear from instructional designers every week.

I need...	Use this	Why
A workshop deck by tomorrow.	Gamma + Canva	Fast draft, then quick polish.
A quick explainer video.	HeyGen + ElevenLabs	Script-to-video, no filming, no mic dread.
An animated training video.	Vyond	Great for scenarios, storytelling, corporate training.
A professional graphic or job aid.	Canva AI	You don't need to be a designer to make it look safe.
Voiceover without hiring talent.	ElevenLabs	Natural voices, no recording studio, no cringe.
To prototype a course fast.	Claude or ChatGPT → Gamma → Storyline	Fast draft → quick structure → interactive prototype.
To record a software demo.	Camtasia	Industry standard for a reason.
To turn messy SME notes into something usable.	Claude or ChatGPT	Refining, not rewriting from scratch.
To edit video and add captions quickly.	Descript	Edit by editing text, auto-captions, quick fixes.
To compare AI outputs before committing.	Multi (getmulti.ai)	Run the same prompt across multiple models. Pick the best one.

This isn't an exhaustive list — but these are the scenarios where IDs most often get stuck.

From SME Notes to Learning Asset in 30 Minutes

What an experienced designer actually does

A real workflow — from chaos to asset — with decisions and sequencing.

Input: SME notes (Word doc brain dump) · One learning objective · Audience: new managers · Deadline: end of week
Goal: Workshop deck · Short explainer video · Basic interactive eLearning prototype

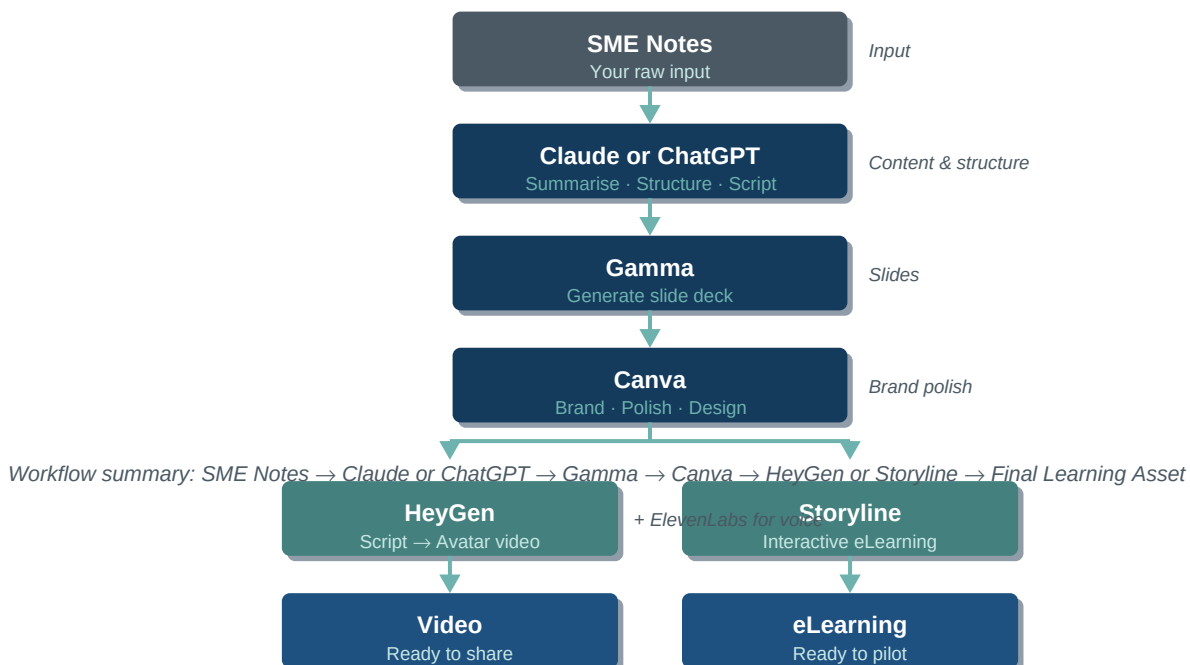
Step 1 – Clarify and structure	Claude or ChatGPT: Summarise, organise into sections, draft outline and script.
Step 2 – Build first slide deck	Gamma: Paste outline. Draft deck with sections, clean structure and basic copy.
Step 3 – Brand and refine	Canva: Apply brand kit, Magic Edit for visual tweaks, templates for a polished result.
Step 4 – Create explainer video	HeyGen for avatar video. ElevenLabs for natural narration.
Step 5 – Build interactive version	Storyline: Simple scenario, branching interactions, clickable prototype.

Outputs: Workshop deck · Explainer video · Interactive eLearning prototype
Time: Roughly 30 minutes of focused work, if you're not starting from zero.

Common AI Tool Mistakes

- Buying five tools before mastering one
- Using Storyline when Rise would do
- Creating videos before validating content
- Thinking better tools solve poor prompts

The 30-Minute AI Workflow



Tool Scorecard

Ease · Speed · Output Quality — rated out of 5

A quick sanity check for when you're weighing up your options. These reflect real-world use, not marketing pages.

Tool	Ease	Speed	Quality	Sweet spot
Gamma	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★■	First draft decks, fast structure
Canva / Canva AI	★★★★★	★★★★■	★★★★★	Brand polish, graphics, job aids
HeyGen	★★★★■	★★★★★	★★★★■	Quick avatar explainer videos
ElevenLabs	★★★★■	★★★★★	★★★★★	Natural narration, no mic needed
Descript	★★★★■	★★★★★	★★★★■	Video edits + captions quickly
Vyond	★★★██	★★★★■	★★★★■	Animated scenarios and storytelling
Storyline	★★███	★★███	★★★★★	Complex interactivity, full control
Rise	★★★★★	★★★★■	★★★★■	Fast responsive web courses
Camtasia	★★★██	★★★██	★★★★★	Screen recording + software demos
ChatGPT	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★■	Drafting, summarising, ideation
Claude	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	Long-form, nuanced content + analysis
Gemini	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★■	Google Workspace + fast research
Perplexity	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★■	Cited research, trend scans
NotebookLM	★★★★■	★★★★■	★★★★★	Deep synthesis from source docs
Multi	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	Compare models, pick the best output
Midjourney	★★★██	★★★██	★★★★★	High-quality professional imagery

★ = star rating (text, not image). ★★★★★ = excellent · ★★★ = good · ★★ = expect friction

Quick selection rules

How to choose when you're not sure

When you need...	Recommended...	Why
Speed and structure	Gamma	Fastest path from outline to deck
Web course, mobile-friendly	Rise (Articulate 360)	Quick authoring, responsive design
Brand polish	Canva	Easy branding, safe visuals
Quick avatar video	HeyGen	Script-to-video, no filming
Quality narration	ElevenLabs	Natural voices, no mic stress
Real interactivity	Storyline	Full control over scenarios
Long-form content + scripts	Claude	Nuanced, structured, high-quality output
Best model for a prompt	Multi (getmulti.ai)	Compare outputs, pick the winner

When AI may not be the best choice

AI should support professional judgement, not replace it. Consider additional review or alternative approaches when:

- Working with confidential or regulated information
- Creating legally sensitive or compliance-critical content
- Designing assessments requiring rigorous validation
- Making decisions that require SME approval or organisational sign-off

Want the prompts behind the workflow?

The **C.R.A.F.T.™ Prompt Toolkit** shows you how to use these tools well.

- Proven frameworks for writing better prompts
- Prompts for slides, scripts, graphics, and learning content
- A repeatable system for getting better outputs from AI

↓ **Download the C.R.A.F.T.™ Prompt Toolkit — trainerfy360.com**

Want practical AI-Enabled Instructional Design tips?

- The AI-Enabled ADDIE™ Playbook
- Prompt libraries and workflow templates
- Courses and consulting for AI-ready L&D; teams

↓ **Join the Trainerfy360 list — trainerfy360.com**

You don't need to be an AI expert. You just need a better system.